I have to admit they knew their business. To this day, I wear the kind of shirts they—and Jimmy Cagney's shirtmaker—helped design.

Next stop: Publicity.

The first item on the agenda was a meeting to choose my name.

Max Arnow and several Warner Brothers press agents sat around a table staring at me, making me feel like a mannequin who was supposed to be seen but not heard.

Going through their minds was the question: What name does he *look* like?

Ignoring me, they'd suggest a name, rule it out, then start over again, getting nowhere.

Finally I interrupted and they looked at me as if I'd done something wrong. The mannequin could speak.

I said, "May I point out that I have a lot of name recognition in a large part of the country, particularly in the Middle West, where I've been broadcasting sports. I think a lot of people would recognize my name on theater marquees."

One of them said "Dutch Reagan? You can't put Dutch Reagan on a marquee."

I had never liked my first name and in school and on the radio, I'd always used my nickname. But I made a spot decision that I'd be happier using my real name rather than some moniker dreamed up by a press agent, and so I ventured inquiringly:

"How about Ronald? . . . Ronald Reagan?"

They looked at each other and began repeating it to one another, "Ronald Reagan . . . Ronald Reagan . . ."

"Hey, that's not bad," one said.

Pretty soon you would have thought *they* had thought it up. Everyone began chiming in their agreement.

And so it was decided, then and there, that I could remain Ronald Reagan.